

Peak Season Household Goods Delays and Limited Temp Housing Options

Globally, April through September is peak moving season for the household goods moving industry. Simultaneously, this is when the relocation industry experiences their highest volumes as well. Generally during peak season, move carriers become constrained in their services, experience more delays in delivery and have limited ability to quickly change pack and load and/or delivery dates.

This year is no different. Amazon is experiencing another record breaking season for relocations. During this time, employees are more likely to experience issues with household goods shipments, corporate temporary housing, and permanent housing. To ease the impact on your move, Amazon Global Relocation Services is providing you with some information and tips as we compete for suppliers with other companies moving employees to areas where Amazon does business.

- **Household Goods Shipments:** Move carriers are operating at full capacity from April to September as the industry faces higher demand resulting in significant shortages in trucks, crews, and drivers to pack and deliver household goods. During this period, you may experience delays in delivery. It will also be more difficult to request changes to established delivery dates as providers are on very tight schedules to meet various needs based upon high volume.

What can I do? To mitigate delays in your household goods delivery, we recommend booking as far in advance as possible and avoiding changes to the extent that you can. We understand that changes will occur, so pack your patience and work with your Graebel consultant to explore creative options. Other options for those experiencing delays may include rent in lieu, rental furniture, hotel stays, etc.

- **Temporary Housing:** Real estate is a hot commodity these days resulting in limited supply of both temporary and permanent housing. The rental and real estate markets have become very competitive in many locations where Amazon does business resulting in reduced inventory and increases in prices.
- **What can I do?** To minimize the impact that the limited housing inventory may have on you, please work with your Graebel consultant on alternatives such as rental furniture support for permanent housing to avoid the stay in corporate housing. In addition, please note due to the limited availability of temporary corporate apartments, you may be placed in hotels for part or all of your temp housing benefit. Amazon is doing everything we can to make your stay as comfortable as possible, however due to peak season, you may experience placement in temporary housing outside of your desired area, last minute changes to temporary housing, and when it comes to permanent housing a strategy that involves identifying multiple options to pursue. Your Graebel consultant and local partner will work closely with you to try and minimize the impact.
- **Need more help?** With any increase in volume also comes potential increases in escalations. Please reach out directly to Global Relocation Services as we are able to address your concerns more quickly and directly with our relocation resources and contacts.

What can I do? Please feel free to reach out to the Global Relocation Services Team via Trouble Ticketing C: Human Resources T: Relocation I: (choose the appropriate option)